

Storytelling for Career Readiness

2-hour Workshop

Instructor Name

Date

Agenda

- Warm-Up
- Storytelling frameworks
- Group story-building
- Interview role-plays
- Your personal story and brief introduction
- Wrap-up

Warm-up: Cloud in a post

Write one sentence and include the following:

- Explain one thing you learned about AWS in your course.
- Write it as if you were posting it on social media for someone who knows nothing about the cloud.
- Keep it short.



You have 3 minutes! Go!

Examples



I learned how the cloud works so your apps don't crash when everyone's online at the same time.



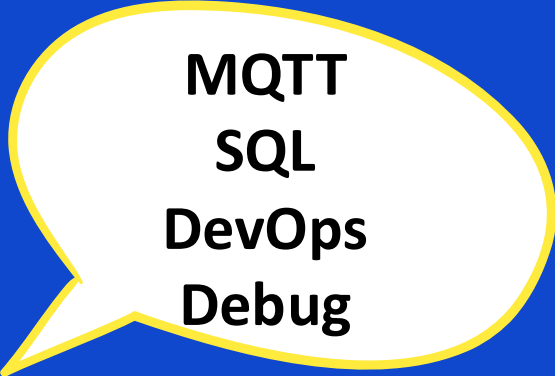
AWS makes it possible for you to build cool stuff without needing a giant server room in your basement.



The cloud is like a streaming service for computer power. You use what you need, when you need it.

Why streamlining is tough

- You default to technical explanations
 - Interviewers might not share your background
 - Clarity beats detail



MQTT
SQL
DevOps
Debug

STAR storytelling framework

			
S	T		R
Situation	Task	Action	Result
Set the context by describing the situation you faced.	Break down the challenges by describing your role or responsibility.	Explain what you did to address the situation.	Describe how your actions led to a good result.
The campus lights were on all day in empty rooms.	I was tasked with helping to create a small IoT solution to reduce energy consumption.	I set up motion sensors that sent data to AWS IoT Core and used the basic rule to turn off lights when rooms were empty.	The result was cutting unnecessary electricity use by 20% in the first month.

Behavioral question

Tell me about a time when you had to troubleshoot a complex IoT issue. What was your approach?

S	T	A	R
Situation	Task	Action	Result
In a class project, our IoT sensors suddenly stopped sending data to the cloud.	I needed to find the issue and restore the data flow.	I checked each part of the system, including the sensors, network, and AWS IoT Core. I discovered the device certificates weren't matching, so I recreated them and tested the connection with the MQTT client.	The sensors reconnected, the data appeared instantly on the dashboard, and our team was able to finish the project on time.

STAR: Cloud in a post 2.0



I learned how the cloud works so your apps don't crash when everyone's online at the same time.

S	T	A	R
Situation	Task	Action	Result
In my AWS class, we were given a project to understand why apps crash when too many people use them at once.	My task was to learn how the cloud can prevent that and apply it in a small demo.	I set up an app using AWS services like AWS Auto Scaling and Elastic Load Balancing.	The app stayed online without crashing, and I learned how the cloud keeps applications stable, even when many users are on at the same time.

Jargon-heavy IoT explanation

We used MQTT over TLS with edge functions, microservices, and a multi-Region Amazon S3 backend to handle telemetry ingestion.



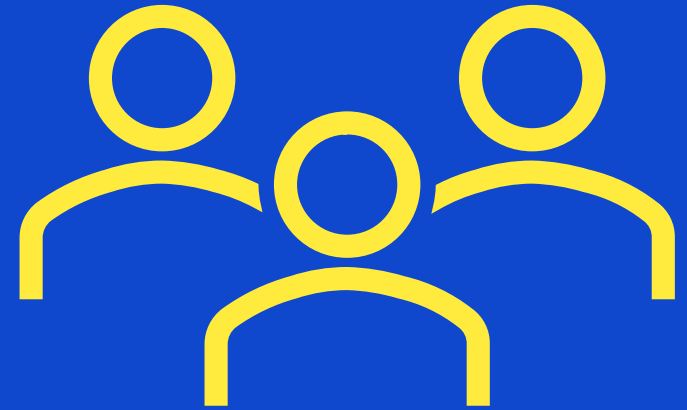
Clear business story

We installed sensors that detected empty classrooms and turned off lights automatically, which cut energy bills and reduced the carbon footprint.



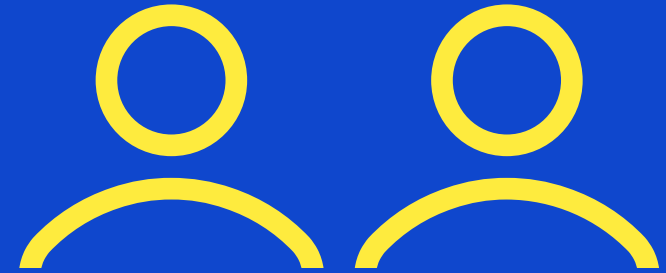
Why it works

- Clear structure
 - Plain language
 - Business impact
 - Human- or customer-centered explanation



Story-building

- Work in pairs
 - Choose a scenario (smart campus, healthcare, agriculture, logistics).
 - Build a 2–3-minute story using STAR.

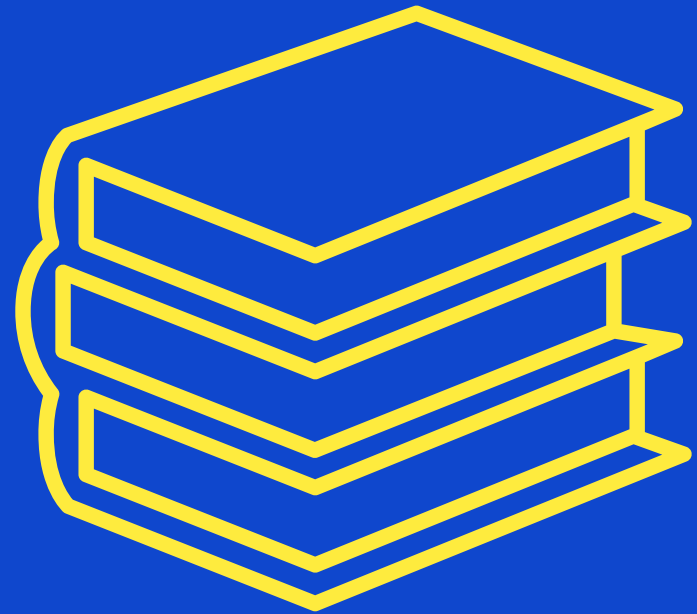


Scenario examples

- **Smart campus:** Sensors, automation, safety
- **Healthcare:** Patient monitoring, alerts, efficiency
- **Agriculture:** Crop data, soil sensors, yield
- **Logistics:** Tracking, routing, optimization

Group work instructions

1. Draft a story.
2. Practice delivery.
3. Prepare to share.



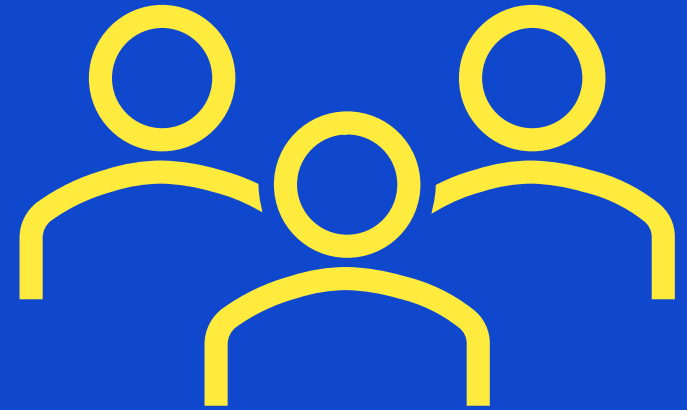
Group work debrief

- Share your experience.



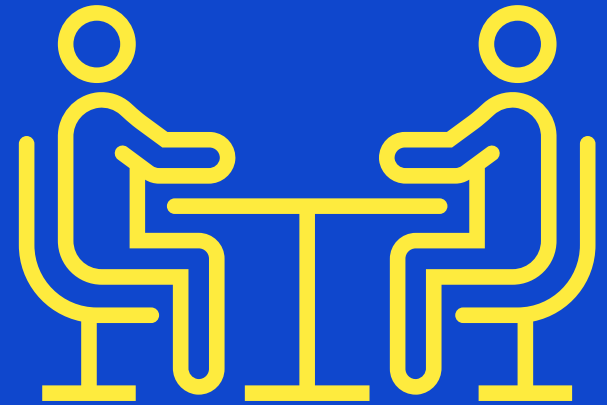
Interview role-plays

- **Triads:** Interviewer, candidate, observer
- Rotate through roles.
- Practice clarity under pressure.



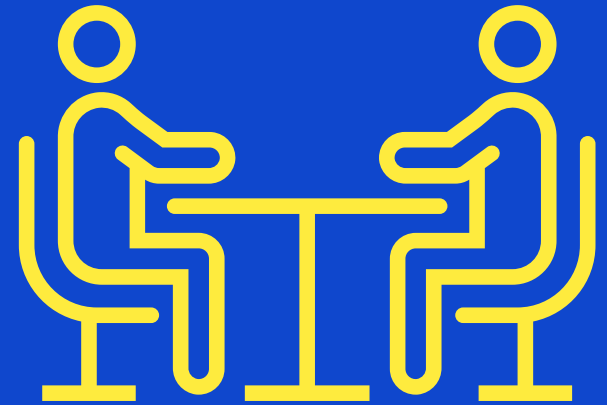
Technical interview prompts

- Explain the data flow in the following ways:
 - How does the device communicate?
 - Explain the architecture.



Non-technical interview prompts

- How does this save money?
- How does this improve the user experience?
- Why does this matter?



Observer checklist

- What was clear?
- What was confusing?
- Where did jargon show up?
- Did the story follow STAR?



Probing tips for interviewers

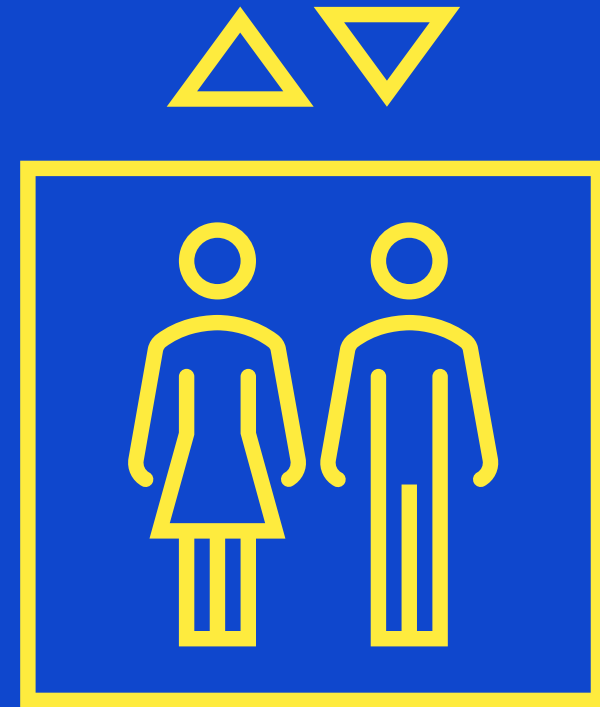
- Ask follow-up questions.
- Don't let candidates rehearse one perfect answer.
- Ask them to explain it to a grandparent.



30-second brief introduction

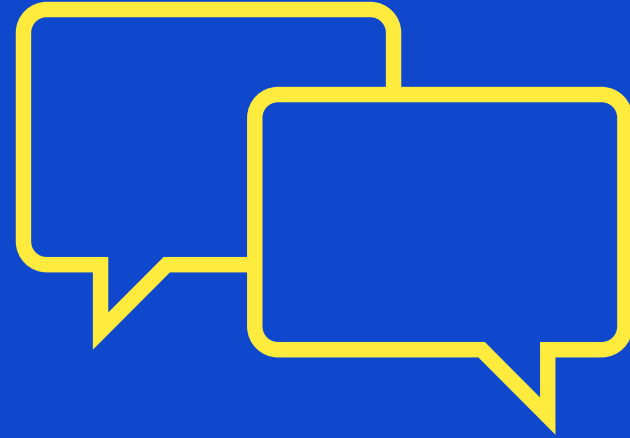
Include the following:

- Who you are
- What you've done
- What you want
- Your call to action



Activity: Pair feedback

- Exchange introductions, then do the following:
 - Use the feedback checklist.
 - Refine wording to be authentic.



Brief introduction checklist

- Clear introduction
- Relevant experience
- Basic explanation of skills
- Specific ask or direction



Avoid over-structuring

- Don't recite STAR mechanically. Instead, do the following:
 - Speak naturally
 - Use your own voice



Wrap-up

- One tip you will take forward
- **Next steps:** Daily prompts and peer practice

Thank you

You've built technical skills. Now tell your story with clarity!